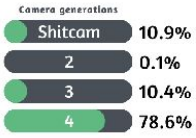
Croatia

Identifying Croatia

.HR



Croatia has long, **white licence plates**. Some plates have a blue strip on the left, some are fully white. Most cars seen in Generation 3 will not feature a blue strip on their licence plates. In addition, there is a mix of cars with or without blue strips in Generation 4, with blue strips more common on newer cars.

NOTE: Blue strips are more common along the coast due to travelling tourists from other EU countries such as Italy.

Croatian **bollards** are white with a black rectangle and red or white reflector. From the top, it is shaped like a triangle.

*NOTE: Hungarian and Lithuanian bollards look similar, but have more **rounded** edges compared to Croatia's sharper edges. Lithuanian bollards will also have an orange reflector. North Macedonia sometimes uses similar bollards, however the country is only covered in Generation 3.*

Čč Ćć Đđ Šš Žž

Svakome su dostupna sva prava i slobode navedene u ovoj Deklaraciji bez razlike bilo koje vrste, kao što su rasa, boja, spol, jezik, vjera, političko ili drugo mišljenje, nacionalno ili društveno porijeklo, imovina, rođenje ili drugi pravni položaj.

Croatian is a **Slavic** language. It is always written in the Latin alphabet. 'IJE' is common in Croatian whereas Serbian uses only 'E' instead.

NOTE: The Slovene language also features a lot of 'J's. Serbian and Montenegrin are also very similar, but Serbia and Montenegro use both Latin and Cyrillic script.

Croatia features chevrons with a **red** arrow on a **yellow** or **white** background.

Croatia has **square (B-type) guardrails**.

NOTE: Croatia is one of the few European countries that use B-type guardrails. For a good overview of European guardrails, see [this infographic.]

Generation 3 coverage often has a non-standard car blur where the **side mirrors** of the car are partially visible. This is not unique to Croatia, but by far most common there.

*NOTE: Sometimes, you can see a small circular **yellow** sticker on the car mirror. This sticker is unique to Croatia.*

Another quirk of Generation 3 coverage is that the majority of it was made in **autumn**. This means that the vegetation in this coverage will often have distinct yellowish or orange fall colours.

Take note that this seasonal meta is not found in Generation 4 coverage.

A black generation 4 car that will never have an antenna can be found in Croatia.

NOTE: A black car can be found in many European countries, though it will often have an antenna visible.

A white generation 4 car that will never have an antenna can be found in Croatia.

NOTE: A white car can be found in many European countries, though it will often have an antenna visible.

Stickers with the letters **HR** can be found on Croatian cars. HR stands for Hrvatska, the Croatian name for Croatia.

NOTE: These were mainly used before EU plates were introduced, meaning they will be less common in Generation 4.

Croatia has direction signs with a **yellow background** and a **black** outline. They often have a pencil-shaped tip.

NOTE: The other former Yugoslav countries of Slovenia, Serbia, Montenegro and North Macedonia have similar signs. A comparison can be seen here.

Croatian utility poles are cylindrical and made of concrete or wood, often with **alternating hooks** on the wooden poles (somewhat similar to Latvian poles).

Buildings in Croatia sometimes feature exposed **red brick walls**. This architecture is more common in inland areas.

NOTE: This type of architecture can also be found in Slovenia and Serbia.

Croatia features **blue** fire hydrants with two diagonal protrusions on either side. Newer fire hydrants seen in Generation 4 have a smaller top but are still recognisable due to the blue paint.

NOTE: Similar fire hydrants can be found in bordering countries, most commonly in Hungary.

Croatia's pedestrian sign features a **pedestrian with a belt** and a zebra path with 5 stripes.

NOTE: The pedestrian on Slovenia's sign does not have a belt.

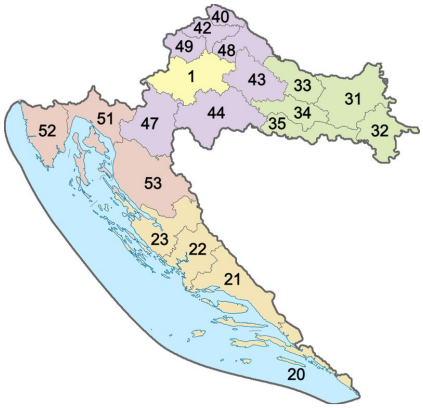
Karlovačko and **Ožujsko** are common Croatian beer companies, with advertisements seen around the country.

Konzum and **Plodine** are common supermarket chains, mostly found in big cities. Plodine is exclusive to Croatia, while Konzum also operates stores in Bosnia.

Croatia does not have Generation 2 car coverage. However, in some historic downtown areas, a **Generation 2 trekker** camera was used.

NOTE: In some of this trekker coverage, the Google employee's red cap is visible.

Regional and county-specific clues



Croatian landlines typically start with a zero followed by the **area code**.

The north-eastern region of Croatia is mostly **flat** and features a lot of agriculture. It is similar in terms of landscape to Hungary and north-western Serbia.

The region north and west of Zagreb is **hilly** and **agricultural**.

The Adriatic coast features **rocky** mountains similar to those seen in Montenegro or Albania. Shrubs are more common instead of trees along the coast, especially in the south. This coastal region has a lot of islands and peninsulas.

Houses and walls made of **beige brick** are common on the Adriatic coast. They often feature **green** shutters.

NOTE: Similar architecture can also be found in some regions in Italy. Additionally, Croatian shutters can also be white, beige etc.

The north-western region of Istria, south of the Italian city of Trieste, sometimes has distinct **red** soil.

Bilingual street name signs with Croatian and **Italian** are typically found in Istria, especially in the western cities.

Town names ending with "**-ec**" are common to see in the northern parts of central Croatia.

Spotlight

Croatia's capital Zagreb has a distinct **big city feel**. Apartment blocks can be seen throughout the city. The northern part of the city is hilly. Furthermore, Zagreb has blue electric trams.

NOTE: In addition to regular car coverage, Zagreb also has various urban sidewalk trekkers, often made with a Generation 2 camera.

Zagreb and Osijek are the only two cities in Croatia with **trams**.

The region northeast of Zadar is recognizable as it is flat with a **mountain** ridge visible in the distance north.

There are a lot of vineyards around the town of **Ilok**, near the Serbian **border**, west of Novi Sad. You can find vineyards in other parts of Croatia as well, but they are most common in this area. If you see lots of vineyards in a northeastern Croatian landscape, you are more often than not near Ilok.

Traffic lights in Rijeka are held up by **long blue poles** that extend out over the road. These are exclusive to the city.

The town of Petrinja was severely damaged by an earthquake in 2020. As a result, many buildings can be seen **ruined** and undergoing repair.

The city of Dubrovnik in the far south of coastal Croatia is famous for its beautifully preserved **medieval city walls**, which can be seen from many points in and around the Old Town.

These tall **cypress trees** are commonly found near the southern tip of Croatia.

Maps and resources

GeoGuessr's own official maps are not very good, for a variety of reasons. Plonk It recommends you play these maps instead:

- **A Balanced Croatia** (map link) - 100k+ computer generated locations.

- **IntersectionGuessr - Croatia · Hrvatska** (map link) - 70k+ pinpointable computer generated locations.

In addition, here are some resources to help you practise Croatia:

> - **Plonk It Croatia** (map link) - This map contains locations for practising each meta in the Plonk It Croatia guide from step 2 to 3.